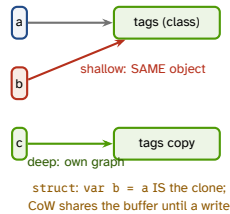
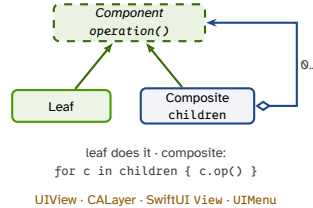
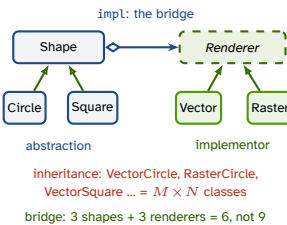
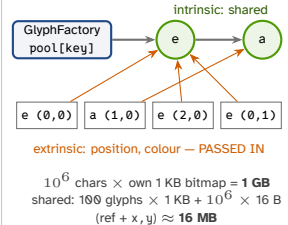


In one line: **Prototype** (creational) — make a new object by *copying a configured instance*. **Composite** — leaf and group behind *one interface*, a tree the client walks uniformly. **Bridge** — split *abstraction* from *implementation* so two axes vary independently ($M \times N \rightarrow M + N$). **Flyweight** — share immutable *intrinsic* state, pass *extrinsic* state in. In Swift, value types + CoW are Prototype, and an enum holding [Self] is Composite.

Prototype: shallow vs deep**Composite: uniform tree****Bridge: $M \times N \rightarrow M + N$** **Flyweight: share the immutable**

Prototype (creational) GoF: “specify the kinds of objects to create using a prototypical instance, and create new objects by copying this prototype”. Use when construction is expensive, configured at runtime, or the type is hidden behind a protocol (“another like *this*”). Roles: Prototype (clone) · ConcretePrototype · Client; optional **prototype registry** (key → prototype).

Shallow = new top object, *shared* referenced objects; **deep** = the whole graph copied.

Foundation: NSCopying.copy(with:) (zone ignored) · mutableCopy(). Foundation copies are **SHALLOW**; copy() of an *immutable* NSArray may return **the same instance**.

Deeper: NSArray(array:copyItems: true) (one level), NSKeyedArchiver or Codable encode→decode (whole graph).

Swift: struct/enum copy on assignment;

Array/Dictionary/Set/String are **copy-on-write** (custom: isKnownUniquelyReferenced). Prototype **dissolves into value semantics**; write clone() only for class graphs.

vs Factory: builds from scratch by choosing a type; Prototype copies a *configured instance*.

Composite (structural) GoF: “compose objects into tree structures to represent part-whole hierarchies; lets clients treat individual objects and compositions uniformly”. Roles:

Component · Leaf · Composite (holds [Component], implements operation by recursing) · Client. **iOS:** UIView/CALayer trees; SwiftUI View (Text leaf, VStack container, both View); UIMenu(children:) of UIMenuElement (UIAction leaves + nested UIMenu); file systems.

Where do add/remove go? — transparency vs safety. On **Component** = *transparent*: uniform, but a leaf must no-op/throw (**LSP** smell); GoF favours it, and UIKit does it (any UIView accepts subviews). On **Composite** only = *safe*: type-checked, but clients downcast. **Swift:** enum Node { case file(Int), folder([Node]) } + an exhaustive switch — no downcast, no no-op. **vs Decorator:** **one** child, *adds* behaviour vs **many** children, *aggregates*.

```
// Composite: the enum IS the pattern
enum Node { case file(bytes: Int), folder([Node]) }
func size(_ n: Node) -> Int { switch n {
case .file(let b): b
case .folder(let kids): kids.map(size).reduce(0, +) } }
// Flyweight: shared immutable glyphs, extrinsic x,y
final class Glyph { let bitmap: [UInt8] = [] } // expensive
final class GlyphFactory { // lock/actor if shared
private var pool: [Character: Glyph] = [:]
func glyph(_ c: Character) -> Glyph {
if let g = pool[c] { return g }
let g = Glyph(); pool[c] = g; return g } }
struct Char { let glyph: Glyph; let x, y: Float }
```

Bridge (structural) GoF: “decouple an abstraction from its implementation so that the two can vary independently”. Roles:

Abstraction (holds impl) · RefinedAbstraction · **Implementor** (primitive ops) · ConcreteImplementor. The abstraction's high-level ops are built from the implementor's primitives. Use when there are **two independent axes**: notification kind × channel (push/email/SMS), shape × renderer, player UI × playback engine. Swift: a protocol-typed stored property, or generic Shape<R: Renderer> (a static bridge, specialised).

vs Adapter: Bridge is designed **UP FRONT** so both sides can grow; Adapter is **RETROFITTED** to make an existing interface fit (GoF's own distinction). **vs Strategy:** same shape (holds a protocol). Strategy = *one algorithm* the client swaps (behavioural); Bridge = a whole implementation *platform*, and **both sides are hierarchies**.

Flyweight (structural) GoF: “use sharing to support large numbers of fine-grained objects efficiently”. **Intrinsic** = stored in the flyweight, context-free, **immutable**, shared (glyph shape, tree mesh, icon). **Extrinsic** = per use, kept by the client and **passed in** (position, colour). A **FlyweightFactory** caches by key — clients never init one. **iOS:** UIImage(named:) returns from a **system cache** (UIImage(contentsOfFile:) does not cache); icon/tile/glyph caches; string interning. **Cell reuse is an object POOL, not textbook Flyweight:** pool = *exclusive* checkout of *mutable* objects; flyweight = *simultaneous* sharing of *immutable* ones. **vs Singleton:** many shared instances, keyed. Cost: extrinsic state threads through every call; the factory must be thread-safe (NSCache is, a Dictionary is not → actor/lock).

Traps

- ! NSArray.copy() is **shallow**; a **class in a struct** stays shared.
- ! Composite's real decision is **transparency vs safety**, not “a tree”.
- ! Bridge ≠ Adapter (up front vs retrofit) ≠ Strategy (2 hierarchies).
- ! Flyweight shared state must be **immutable** — else a race.

Remember Prototype copies · Composite nests · Bridge splits two axes · Flyweight shares the immutable.